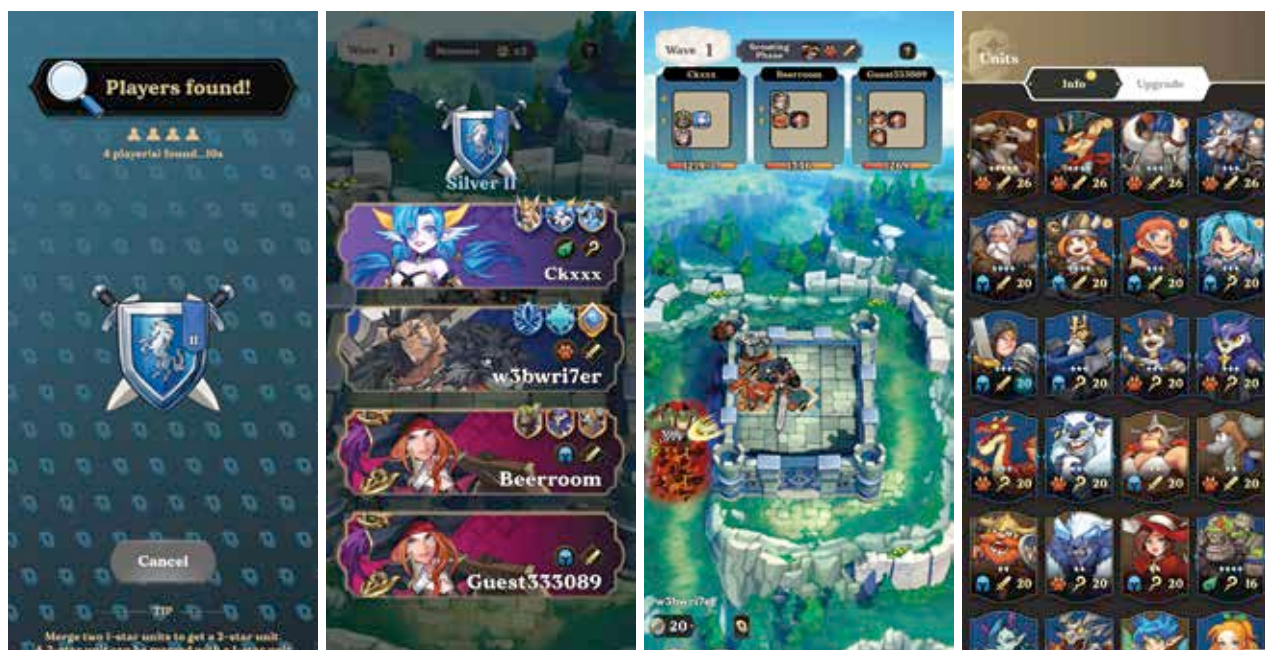




The gameplay

Ranking up in the game playing Derby Games has an impact on several gameplay elements. Primarily, your Derby's hit point bar.

The first two winners of each battle are ranked up, the third winner keeps to their rung on the rank ladder. The loser ranks down. Essentially: Avoid being dead last. Winning regularly also drops two currencies that allow you to try your luck in the game's spin-to-win menu, and also to purchase unit upgrades. These change weekly and seasonally, respectively, so fair warning to resource hoarders, you may find yourselves in trouble when the cycles refresh.

There are two main game modes: Derby and Blitz. Derby games help players rank up by playing PvP. Blitz games are purely PvE and currently seem to be the only way to gain talent points, which can be redeemed in the game's Talent menu to give buffs to particular factions or unit types. There are several smaller game modes in the 'Adventure' menu of the game. There's the Valley of Trials which refreshes each day to help you improve your game with variations of factions and types. There's the 'Friendly Derby' which allows for friends to play together. And

the Themed mode where the developers seem to try small variations to keep Derby games interesting. There's also an 'Arena' in development.

Defense Derby has a Guild system in place, which would indicate a potential 'Guild Wars' element in future updates. For readers interested: Skoar! Has its own guild, open to players, so search for SKOAR, if you'd like to join us.

Money, money, money

Despite having eight different currencies in the game, Defense Derby does a pretty good job keeping it fair. There is a paid currency, but players won't really feel the need to indulge in micro-transactions because reward drops, even for the paid stuff, are steady throughout the game. Here's a quick lowdown on the currencies in the game:

Gems are the premium currency of the game and can be bought and consumed for unit cards or other currencies. Cubics are the more common reward drops and can be used to get more unit cards. Faction Crystals are three types, one for each faction.

MOAR!

DEVELOPER
Rising Wings

PUBLISHER
Krafton Inc.

PLATFORMS AVAILABLE
iOS, Android

PLATFORM TESTED ON
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They're rarer and work like Cubics, but guarantee units from a specific faction. Crystals are essentially faction crystals, but can be used as replacement currency for any of the faction crystals. Gold and Elixer are used to upgrade and level your units. Eternal Feathers and Doubloons are the spin-to-win currencies. Personally, just doing my dailies and weeklies, I've found it all to be fairly easy to level up my

account and rarely find myself underpowered. That said, there may not be enough pay-to-win players in the game right now, so the playing field may change, given time.

The Verdict

All-in-all, Defense Derby's kept me engaged longer than I expected. The balance of RNG and strategy is great, allowing players to rely on skill, adaptive thinking and luck equally to move forward. For all you mobile gamers out there looking for a fun game to pass time on long commutes and in-between waiting on world bosses to spawn: Give it a shot! *